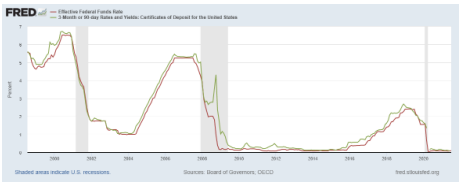
Economics 23950

Economic Policy Analysis

Fall Quarter 2021



Effective Federal Funds Rate and 90 day USA CD Rate. Source: FRED series FEDFUNDS and IR3TCD01USM156N

Prerequisites

This class assumes you are comfortable with the contents and pre-requisites of ECON 20200. Econ 21020 or 21030 are also recommended, but not required.

Measured Learning Objectives

Identify fiscal and monetary policy

Apply general equilibrium methods of the macroeconomy to analyze the effects of fiscal policy and monetary policy

Synthesize theoretical predictions (simulated or calculated) with economic data

Evaluate statements about the implications of fiscal and monetary policy

Modify models to consider policy impacts under different environments or assumptions.

Analyze news events or opinion pieces using economic methods.

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Schedule	Econ 23950-2	Econ 23950-3
Class	MW 2:00-3:20pm	MW, 3:30pm-4:50pm
Discussion	Fri, 2:30pm-3:20pm	Fri, 3:30pm-4:20pm

Course Description

Department Website: Building on the tools and methods that are developed in the core courses, this course analyzes fiscal and monetary policy and other topical issues. We use both theoretical and empirical approaches to understand real-world problems.

Explained: This course will use the theoretical, numerical, and empirical methods from the core sequence to analyze macroeconomic policies. Rather than diving deep into a single policy topic, we will take a helicopter-tour approach across taxation, government debt, unemployment, and monetary policy to highlight how applications may differ (or not!) across topics. You will write three policy analysis briefs, two selected from provided prompts and one on a fiscal or monetary policy of your choosing. You should check news sources discussing current economic policies to help with this selection. Examples include, but are not limited to, Wall Street Journal, the Economist, and NPR's Planet Money podcast. You may also use international policies (and news sources) as long as they are credible!

Course Organization

I write all slides, handouts, prompts, and questions. In class, I will discuss application of the course material and solve/derive a few properties, skipping math steps I assume you are comfortable with after the Econ core sequence. Homework assignments will revisit these problems, or variations thereof, requiring that you revisit some necessary steps. During Discussion section, TAs will revisit the problems to show you the math steps in greater detail. Discussion section will review the problems, with a focus on homework applications.

I have an "open-floor" policy but expect you to be respectful of everyone in the classroom and ask you to engage in professional behavior. Please stop me and ask questions at any time if you cannot keep up with the material presented. When I ask you to form a group to check/discuss your answers with others, please do so: I am helping you improve your communication skills and improve your understanding.

Assume that if you do not tell or ask me directly, I am unaware of issues or questions you may have

PROFESSOR
Dr. G.C. Pieters

OFFICE HOURS (ON ZOOM, SEE CANVAS)	
Mon	11:00am – Noon
Tues	1:00pm-3:00pm
Wed	-
Thu	-
Fri	10:00-11:00am

PREFERRED SALUTATION
Dr. Pieters or Prof. Pieters She/Her/Hers

CAMPUS POLICIES



Family Educational Rights & Privacy Act

FERPA is a federal statute that, guarantees privacy over certain aspects of your educational records. You can view the details of the policy here[1].

By attending, you are agreeing to be recorded. Note that in some situations photographing, recording, or broadcasting parts of class, discussion sections, or office hours without permission, will violate not only various privacy or eavesdropping laws, but also the FERPA statute.

Responsible Employees

All University of Chicago faculty and TAs are classified as "responsible employees"; they are required to report any discussions of sexual misconduct, including the identities of the student making the complaint and alleged perpetrator. You will receive an email once a report is filed but are not obligated to meet with anyone or engage in the process. In contrast, Confidential Resource Individuals do not have to share identifying information. Find more information, including phone-numbers, here[2].

Personal Recording Or Distributing Audio, Video, or Photographs

The Recording and Deletion Policies for the current academic year can be found in the Student Manual under Petitions, Audio & Video Recording on Campus[3].

- Do not record, share, or disseminate any course sessions, videos, transcripts, audio, or chats.
- Do not share links for the course to those not currently enrolled.
- Any Zoom cloud recordings will be automatically deleted 90 days after the completion of the recording.

COVID-19

I have designed this class so that no assignment or deadline needs to change if we need to switch to hybrid or online-only instruction this quarter again. I will have an online-only office hours available for the entire quarter. I may hold in-person office hours as well, depending on campus policy.

The University's GoForward[4] website has COVID Updates relevant to the campus community. All students on campus are required to adhere to the guidelines in the UChicago Health Pact[5] in order to promote a safe environment. Any concerns over inappropriate PPE usage, physical distancing, cleaning/disinfection, or other COVID-19 related public health concerns should be directed to UCAIR[6]. If there is an emergency, call 773-702-8181 or dial 123 on any campus phone. If you are potentially exposed to COVID-19 or your COVID-19 test results come back positive, immediately notify (email) C19HealthReport@uchicago.edu**.**

Students who have been exposed to, or who are experiencing symptoms of COVID-19, should immediately contact UChicago Student Wellness[7] to be tested and reach out to the area Dean of Students to request accommodations for classes until:

- At least 10 days have passed since symptoms first appeared and;
- At least 3 days (72 hours) have passed since recovery – defined as resolution of fever without the use of fever-reducing medications and improvement in respiratory symptoms (e.g. cough, shortness of breath).

Diversity Statement

The University of Chicago is committed to diversity and rigorous inquiry that arises from multiple perspectives. I share this commitment: we have the highest quality interactions and can solve problems more creatively when we recognize and share our diversity of perspectives. I expect to maintain a productive learning environment based on open communication, mutual respect, and non-discrimination among students, teaching assistants, support staff, and myself as the lead instructor of the course, even as we may engage in strenuous and critical debates.

Any suggestions promoting a positive and open environment are appreciated and given serious consideration: there can always be a gap between my intention and reality. *Correct me on your preferred name, pronunciation, and gender pronouns if needed.* If we are meeting using Zoom, remember to update your display name on Zoom to reflect your preferred salutation. You can change the name displayed in Zoom by right-clicking on your video and selecting "rename". Pronunciation guides are always appreciated.

Workload Statement

This course adheres to The University of Chicago's standard expectations for workload: students should spend an average of 10 hours a week outside of class time and discussion-sections engaging with the material (including class time, **the total is approximately 14 hours per week**).

Do not confuse "sitting with the book open" as "engaging the material". Recognize this is an *average* expectation, and the deviation can be large. Your course grade will not be adjusted based upon how many hours you report working on the material: you can spend many hours, and still not achieve the level of understanding required for a passing grade.

CAMPUS RESOURCES

Mental Health Services 773-702-4156

Students differ in how much they know about mental health services. In the USA your use of mental health services is not linked to your academic file; it is confidential. In general, psychiatrists assign medication while psychologists will talk with you. Both are trained to help you get the kind of assistance you need.

There are no rewards for "toughing it out". If you experience mental, physical, or other problems immediately contact Student Health and Counseling Services[8] (SHCS). I provide all accommodations officially requested by SHCS. These are 3 programs I know students use:

- Let's Talk[9]: Drop-in; doesn't require an appointment.
- Therapy Groups[10]: For people going through similar tough experiences.
- Counseling:[11] Short-term. Focused on a specific issue, with a short-term goal.

SHCS offers Health and Wellness initiatives as well, including the Academic Skills Assessment Program (ASAP)[12], which helps students improve their academic performance by addressing a number of issues that can interfere with effective learning, including time management, learning and memory, test anxiety, reading effectiveness, effective exam preparation, and general study skills. The ASAP program offers quarterly workshops and brief one-on-one appointments.

Health

It is easy to think that you should "just push through" and finish assignments, even if you are exhausted. This is bad. Your brain is responsible for your future success and it needs to be taken care of—that means taking care of yourself. If you are exhausted you can neither think creatively, nor reason soundly. Take a break! It is not laziness; it is self-preservation to make sure you will thrive for future years. Learn how to set and enforce these boundaries: plan blocks of "recovery and rejuvenation time" in whatever form that works for you.

Disabilities

I will evaluate you on your understanding of the material in this course, NOT your understanding of the material in this course while you simultaneously undergo a panic attack / work through dyslexia / are unable to take notes / etc. However, I have no medical background and cannot determine appropriate accommodations. Student Disability Services[13] (SDS) will determine what you need. **I cannot provide ANY accommodation until SDS has officially approved your case and informed me of the accommodations you are allowed.** Once approved, I will provide all the accommodations officially requested by SDS.

Timely notifications are required in order to ensure that your accommodations can be implemented: some accommodations require advance staffing or technology accommodations that can take time to implement or acquire.

Your use of any accommodation from SDS is confidential and is not recorded on your transcript, nor may I (or anyone else) discuss your use of it. I do not need to know why you received accommodation. Remember that **SDS may take some time (1-3 weeks)** to process your request; perhaps longer in the current environment. Apply early in the quarter if there is *any* chance that you will need accommodation. You are not required to use the accommodation you receive.

College Core Tutoring Program

There is a volunteer tutor program[14] available for some courses. I do not coordinate or interact with the tutoring program in any way. I provide links for on-campus writing resources on the Policy Paper assignment page.

Center for College Student Success

CCSS[15] provides mentoring services to help first-generation, lower-income, and immigrant students succeed in environments like the one at The University of Chicago. Note: "first-generation students" is a broader definition than many realize and can include students whose parents have degrees but did not have a university experience that translates to The University of Chicago.

Laptop Rentals

If you find that your computer is slow or too old to work efficiently, you may be able to borrow a laptop at no charge for up to 8 hours from the Tech Bar at Regenstein[16]. At the time of writing, they are not sure the program will be available.

Many public libraries in the United States offer a similar service for their patrons. For example, Chicago Public Library[17] has laptops, scanners, and Internet-to-Go-WIFI available for lending.

cVPN & vLAB

Many campus network resources require you to be on-campus to access them. If you are not on campus, you should use the (free) university-provided VPN (cVPN)[18] to gain access. Essentially, this makes online university services treat you "as-if" you were using a computer on campus.

vLAB[19] (Virtual Lab) creates a virtual desktop that you can use to access programs typically installed on campus computers. To access it from off-campus, you need to use the cVPN. Programs include everything from Excel to Stata, R to MATLAB. Explorer and Firefox are also included, which may be useful for interacting with certain websites.

Career Advancement

Career advancement[20] has substantial experience working with economics undergraduates to find careers that match their interests – they have far more resources to advise you than I do. Visiting them early will help you make informed choices about classes and/or majors.

CLASS POLICIES

Email



I respond to email within 2 **business days** (Monday-Friday, 9am-5pm). Do not expect a response faster than that or outside of those hours. If I don't respond within this time frame it means I did not receive or notice your email, so please send a follow-up. If the thought of emailing a professor makes you anxious (or you spend hours composing the email) this guide[21] contains email best-practices for communicating with me (different disciplines and instructors have different email expectations). I reserve the right to not respond to a question that is answered on the syllabus, assignment sheet, discussion board, or announcements so make sure you clearly communicate in your email that you have checked those.

Guests/Class Visitor Policy

Economics is awesome! If you have a friend who wants to sit in on this class to see what Economics is about (or visiting family, etc.) they are welcome to sit in on the class as long as (1) you accompany them, (2) they are not disruptive or distracting to the class, and **(3) they completely abide by the campus COVID policy** at the time (which may make it impossible for them to visit). Feel free to introduce them to me before the class starts so that I don't accidently call on them.

Expectations for online behavior

Behaviors such as Zoom bombing and trolling is a violation of both privacy and campus standards of conduct. I expect the same standard of behavior as we would have in a classroom. Do not spam the private or public chat window.

Course Announcements & Additional Materials

Announcements, additional readings, and problem sets will be placed on Canvas. All **registered** students are automatically enrolled in Canvas. **To automatically receive emails when someone posts on the discussion board, I send an email to you using Canvas, or I post an announcement go to account>notifications and set the relevant sections to "notify me right away".** Please keep in mind that Canvas has a surveillance component that tracks and logs all your activity (when/if you logged in, opened a quiz, a document, etc.).

Attendance & Participation Policy

"Not attending class is like renting a hotel room then sleeping on the street."
- Unknown

I am not personally disappointed or offended if you choose to not attend class: your time is scarce and limited, and on occasion, optimizing your utility may require giving other more attention (and yes, those "things" could be sleeping or socializing).

I expect you to attend and participate in class and discussion sections as much as you are able. If you are unable to attend, it is your responsibility to watch the videos, read material, or obtain lecture notes in a timely manner that approximates standard class structure.

Be aware that spending time sleeping, checking email, doing homework for another class, or texting with a friend while attending class, is a version of "busy work" that you are engaging in to give yourself an illusion of working on this class. It is the equivalent of not attending at all. If you have tasks that you deem more important than being present in class, optimize and do not attend.

Sharing of Images, Videos, or Files

If you share files (documents, images, videos, etc.) associated with the course without permission (including but not limited to slides and answer keys), you may be violating privacy laws, copyright laws, Illinois eavesdropping laws, and/or FERPA. This may also apply to any manipulated videos, images, or files.

Technology Statement

You may use a laptop, tablet, or other device for taking notes. You may *not* use a device for any purpose unrelated to our class. ***Do not harm the learning environment of others by watching TV shows/sports/movies/games/reading emails/scrolling through Instagram/TikTok/etc.*** All devices should be silenced and cell phones put away, except in the rare instance that I ask you to use them for an activity. I am easily distracted by the sound of a vibrating cellphone. If there is an urgent need to leave your cell phone on, such as a family emergency or an internship/job interview, sit near the back of the class so that you can step outside with minimum disruption. **Due to privacy laws, any private audio or visual recording of a class, discussion session, or office hours is not allowed unless requested by SDS.**

CLASS RESOURCES

Discussion Boards

I use discussion boards for this course. You should feel free to post AND ANSWER questions on the boards. **I do not mind if people use the board to share answers to the homework questions before the assignment is due**, though I will not respond and say whether the posted answer is right or wrong.

No extra credit is given for participating on the boards but: board response time may be faster than mine; your class cohort may answer questions that I am not willing to answer or answer them in a different (and better) way. When my time is short, I prioritize answering questions on the board above answering email.

On the flip side: it may be helpful to think of questions on the board as practice questions. Trying to answer someone's question is a good way to test your own knowledge of the material. It is better to give a wrong answer on the board and be corrected than being wrong on a graded assessment.

Recorded Videos

If technology and university policy allows, the TAs and I will record the second live class session and each discussion section. Office hours will not be recorded. **For the privacy of others (FERPA and privacy laws), you should not record office hours, classroom discussion, or any one-on-one meetings without permission.**

Teaching Notes

My detailed teaching notes will never be made available for you. Ever. I will, however, post slides I use in each lecture.

Office Hours

Everything in this course is "blind-graded" (students' identities are concealed during the grading process) therefore, attending office hours to incur favorable grading will not work.

- Office hours are open for meetings and discussion with any student enrolled in one of my classes. I will have both appointment-based and drop-in office hours. I will see multiple students at the same time during drop-in hours.
- During office hours: I or the TA answer or guide questions about the homework material, re-teach material in a different way for students who were in class but feel they do not understand it as it was presented, or elaborate on extensions/implications of the material. We will not check your homework answers but can help you with concepts. The difference between the two is in how you phrase your question… (drop by during office hours to learn the difference!)
- The office hours closest to the homework due date are the busiest and focused on that week's homework, the office hours furthest away are the quietest. Choose the office hours that match your goal. Bring your class notes or existing work on the homework problem for reference.
- I have separate office hours for general advising, economics discussions, or meetings about topics not related to course material. You can come to these "Econ department office hours" regardless of whether you are (or have ever been) in one of my classes or not. These "Econ office hours" are emailed to the Econ Major list host at the beginning of the quarter.
- Outside of class and office hours, my time is already allocated to other aspects of my job. I am generally not available for impromptu (drop-in) meetings, though I may be available for scheduled meetings with enough planning time.

BUG BOUNTIES

If you find an error in a provided handout, I will give you 0.5 points on the homework associated with that material. For example, suppose there is a typo on Slide 1, which is covered in Homework 1: if you are the first to post on the "Bug Bounty" discussion board, you can get a bonus of 0.5 points on Homework 1. There is no transferring of points across assignments or exceeding the maximum score of the homework assignment. The bug bounty is available the entire quarter until the end of the final exam time slot for the class and can retroactively increase your homework score even outside of the seven-day regrade window. Everyone in your homework group will benefit from the bug bounty.

If you think you have found an error you **must** post it to the dedicated Canvas discussion boards (the Bug Bounty board) so that (1) everyone knows that it has been found and claimed and (2) if it is not an error, everyone can understand why. I will decide whether the error is significant enough to warrant the bounty.

COURSE TEXTBOOKS
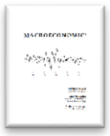
I combine the best parts of multiple books so there is no obvious single reference that can completely encapsulate all the material in this course. Afterall, what's the point of a class if all you need to do is read a book!

That said, I recognize that textbooks can serve as an additional resource if you are struggling with the material or need additional practice problems. Different books are written with different styles and there is no global consensus over which one is the "best". I do not assign mandatory reading or homework from any textbook, but I will indicate helpful chapters on the course schedule. If you find other textbooks that are useful during this quarter, let me know and I will review and potentially add them to this list.

All the following textbooks satisfy two criteria:

1) I have reviewed the book in creating this course,
2) [*Most important*] No student has told me the book is a bad or confusing resource.

Primary:



(DLS) Matthias Doepke, Andreas Lehnert, & Andrew W. Sellgren, *Macroeconomics.* Free online from authors: https://faculty.wcas.northwestern.edu/~mdo738/book.htm

Companion to *Barro, Macroeconomics 5th Edition (1997)*



(GLS) Julio Garín, Robert Lester, & Eric Sims, *Intermediate Macroeconomics*. Available for free download.

(TR) Topical Readings. Articles or news stories that integrate the course content with current events or context. Will be distributed on Canvas, or referenced in homework if a required reading.

Others:

- Stephen Williamson, *Macroeconomics*
- [Too Advanced] David Romer, *Advanced Macroeconomics*.
- [Too Advanced] M. Wickens, *Macroeconomics, 2nd Ed.*
- [Too Basic] Robert Barro: *Macroeconomics: A Modern Approach* (2008).
- [Too Basic] Charles Jones, *Macroeconomics*.

ECONOMICS DEPT. RESOURCES

Econ Department Office Hours

Every quarter I (and all other instructional professors and lecturers in economics), have weekly non-course specific office hours for current, past, or potential econ majors to discuss anything. You can come and talk to me (or any of us) during these times even if you are not currently in a class we are teaching. These times and Zoom room ID or office hours are emailed out to the econ majors email list (see "Helpful Email Lists", below).

Letters of Recommendation

Send me an email that includes (1) a link to the program to which you are applying, (2) your current resume, (3) your transcript (unofficial is OK), (4) a brief statement that lists 3-4 things that *my* letter can convey which other letter writers cannot. I usually do not write letters of recommendation for students I've only had in one class, or for students who cannot articulate an answer to item 4. I will occasionally make exceptions to this if you were a frequent, active participant in class or on the discussion boards.

Helpful Email Lists

At the bottom of the Undergraduate Econ webpage[22] are email sign-ups for undergraduate econ-targeted announcements about available internships, research assistant jobs, opportunities for majors (for example, joining the Fed Challenge team), or graduate school preparation. You can also find paid and unpaid research opportunities for undergraduates in the CCRF research opportunity database[23].

Economics RSO's

Oeconomica[24] has year-round cohorts focused on reading and synthesizing economic research articles. They also have review sessions and run the Econometrics Game. Feel free to let me know if there are other RSOs and I will add them to this section.

COURSE GRADES CALCULATION

	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D+	D
F_g: Fixed % of Total S (240)	92%	90% (216)	88%	82%	80% (192)	78%	72%	70% (168)	68%	60% (144)
D_g: Distribution based*	$\tilde{\mu} + 1.25\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} + \sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} + 0.75\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} + 0.25\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu}$	$\tilde{\mu} - 0.25\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} - 0.75\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} - \sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} - 1.25\,\sigma$	$\tilde{\mu} - 1.5\,\sigma$
S_g: Share of Students	Top 10%, A- or higher		Top 25%, B- or higher			Top 50%, C- or higher				

*The distribution-based cutoffs use the average (μ), median (m), and standard deviation (σ) of S_i, with $\tilde{\mu} = \mu - \frac{1}{3}\max(\mu - m, 0)$

1) Your Homework and QRE are added together for a *timed* component worth 50 points.

- Each QRE question is worth 1 point.
- Each homework assignment is worth 10 points.
- Your QRE scores and your five highest homework scores are combined for a maximum of 50 points: QREs are perfect substitutes for homework assignments and vice versa. It also means that most students will have a surplus of points in this category – the surplus cannot be transferred and will not be used in any way to determine your grade.

2) Your three paper scores and highest four feedback-on-feedback scores are added together for an *untimed component* worth 190 points.

- Each paper is worth 50 points.
- Peer Feedback-on-Feedback is worth 10 points each.

Your Aggregated Individual Score (S_i)

Your aggregated individual score (S_i) is calculated from the combination of the graded components.

$$S_i = Timed\ Component + Untimed\ Component$$

If the class average or median (my choice) on either component is below 70%, I will increase all students' scores on that component using a method of my choice until the targeted moment is 70%. I will NOT decrease scores if the targeted moment is above 70%. The class average on assessments may vary greatly from assignment to assignment and will not be individually curved.

You will receive the highest letter grade for which your *aggregated individual score*, S_i, exceeds the cutoff: $\boldsymbol{S_i \geq C_g}$.If the entire class demonstrates mastery of the material (all scores are higher than the cutoff for an A grade), the entire class gets an A: there is no grade rationing in this course. I will not certify your understanding as mastery (an A grade) if it is not deserved.

Grade Cutoffs $\boldsymbol{C_g = \min\left(F_g, D_g, S_g\right)}$

The default cutoff score for each grade is the "Fixed" cutoff (If you earn over 220.8 points you will receive an A). If needed, I will decrease the cutoff ("curve the class") using either a share-of-students or distribution-based method – whichever results in the lowest cutoff score for each grade. I may further decrease C_g further at my own discretion (for example: if the distribution is not well described by a normal distribution) but *will never increase* C_g. I regularly post cutoff updates on Canvas. Note that the distribution-method may mean your grade is improved if others do better than you – you are not in a competition.

Other Course Grades[25]

(W) "Withdrew from a course": Not used in computing GPA, must be requested by your academic advisor by 5pm on the Friday before Finals week.

(I) "Incomplete" can be granted if you have: (1) completed >50% of the graded work in the class with (2) a passing grade. I *only* assign an "I" grade for an **unforeseeable emergency that is not already accommodated in the syllabus.** I will not grant an "Incomplete" if either of your component scores are in the lowest 30% of the class at the time you make the request. Note that I teach a wide variety of courses in the department so, if you take an "Incomplete", it is highly likely that I will ask someone to assign and assess your remaining work according to their course standard.

(P/F) Pass/Fail: A "Pass" is assigned for all grades above a D**. For a course to be counted toward a degree from the economics department, you must take it for a letter grade.** A pass/fail must be requested by the start of the final exam period.

Other grading Notes

• All your grades and graded work will be available on Gradescope. I will not post scores to Canvas because it cannot calculate grades correctly.

•No "Individual-Only" Extra Credit or "Grade Nudges". There will be NO additional grade assistance unless offered to the entire class. I ignore (and find insulting) all emails that ask for bonus assignments or a "grade nudge". **Everyone has equal opportunity to earn an A grade or to avoid an F**. Grades will NOT be adjusted to reflect the hours you work on the course material, your effort, your class participation, your office hours or discussion section attendance, your personal worth as a student, your financial aid status, etc. Your grades reflect only your understanding of the material as evaluated by assessments. Some students may be able to study for 10 minutes and obtain an A, while others can spend an entire week and receive an F.

EVALUATION & ASSESSMENT POLICIES

Collaboration/Cheating/Plagiarism

Submitting any portion of someone else's work as your own is considered academic dishonesty. Using answer keys, exams, or homework assignments from other classes (past or concurrent) to study or derive your answers, or obtaining the answer from someone not currently enrolled in the course (i.e. buying a homework or quiz aide, farming the answer on a non-Canvas discussion board, etc.) are non-exhaustive examples of submitting someone else's work and will count as academic dishonesty.

• HOMEWORK**: You are allowed to submit homework assignments in groups of any size.** I will not assign or supervise groups – if anything goes wrong, you need to sort it out (for example, if your name was not included on the assignment). Even if you submit your own homework, collaboration and discussion of homework assignments with currently enrolled members of the class is allowed and encouraged! Homework collaboration may result in identical answers and so identical homework assignments will not be penalized. The use of past homework assignments is cheating. **High homework scores cannot be used as evidence of understanding material if contesting grades.**

• QUICK RESPONSE EXERCISES (QRE): You may not simply present a screen capture or photo of the presented solution. Because QREs are intended to be collaboratively solved during live class, it is impossible to distinguish collaboration from plagiarism.

• PAPERS: See the assignment sheet. Papers are the primary way I have of assessing your individual ability. Note that hiring someone to write any part of your paper for you – including the code -- is considered plagiarism.

• CONSEQUENCES: If you are caught attempting to distort my measurement of your individual ability, I will assign you a 0 for that assessment *and any assessment of the same type*: if you hire someone to write your monetary paper, you will get zero on all the papers even if you provide evidence implying you did not cheat. Your case will also immediately be referred to the Dean of Students for additional, formal University of Chicago disciplinary action. At minimum, you will have an academic dishonesty note on your academic record. For extreme first-time or repeat offenses, the disciplinary committee can decide that the consequence of your choice to cheat is expulsion from the University. That can mean deportation from the country for students on visas, failure to graduate for last quarter seniors, or needing to repay financial aid. No matter how much sympathy I may hold for your reasons, I will report any-and-all instances of cheating regardless of the potential cost to you.

Disruption Accommodation

The design of this course allows you to skip two weeks of assignments with no built-in negative impact on your grade: **Do not skip assessments under the assumption you will not need that grace period. I will not grant you that additional opportunity.**

HOMEWORK AND QUICK RESPONSE EXERCISES will not be re-scheduled in the event of a disruption. Instead, only your top five out of six homework scores count and there will be sufficient QREs to effectively "replace" at least one additional homework.

PAPERS: As discussed in the assignment sheet, the indicated paper deadlines are to ensure that I will have enough time to grade your papers (and that you have enough time give and receive feedback) while maintaining a manageable workload. I must submit all grades on December 15. If your paper is not graded by that date, I will assign it a zero score. Except for a delay in feedback, there is no other penalty for late submission of papers. Grading for Peer Reviews can be moved to a different assignment if it is impossible for you to participate. Contact me ASAP if necessary.

• Any requests for accommodation beyond those listed above must include a clear explanation as to why the above accommodations are not enough. Note that almost all homework assignments can be completed at least 48 hours ahead of their deadline and paper assignments are posted at the start of the quarter. In almost all circumstances, there will be no additional accommodation provided beyond that which is already built into the course (SDS, dropping lowest scores, make-up work, QREs in excess of requirement).

Whether I accommodate any request is my decision. Keep in mind that granting accommodations not only requires the "obvious" resources but also requires extra work from the TA, the grader, and myself. Without enough advance notice (usually 2 weeks), we may be physically unable to grant accommodations even if we want to (insufficient time to write a comparable exam, violation of labor contracts, etc.). Poor planning is not a reason for me to inconvenience the TA, the grader, and myself for your accommodation.

ONLINE-SUBMISSION POLICIES & ACCOMODATIONS

Submitting Work on Gradescope



•GENERAL: All graded work will be submitted online through Gradescope. **The deadlines for various assignments are as listed in the class schedule.** A "how-to-submit" video and detailed guide are available here[26]. Instructions on how to submit assignments as a group on Gradescope are here.[27] Remember, only homework assignments are eligible for group submission.

• Submissions are graded per question with student answers randomized and identities hidden (everyones' "4a", then "4b", etc.). For this reason, it is impossible to "refer to answer for the preceding question" or "see graph for previous question". If you find yourself referring to your answer for a prior question, include the graph/picture/etc. again.

• HOMEWORK: The homework due date is **Monday 8:59pm Chicago** time. You can turn in the homework late and without penalty until **Tuesday 8:59am Chicago time**. No additional late assignments will be accepted, nor will due dates be changed. There will be no exceptions to this rule for any individual student, though in extreme cases I may grant it for the class. (For example, if Canvas is down for 24 hours).

Gradescope has native TeX integration: if you type $$x^2_i$$ it will appear as x_i^2 — the dollar signs indicate an equation environment. Make sure your pictures are clearly visible and correctly oriented. You should only submit the images relevant to the question you are answering (not answers to other questions): crop images to ensure this.

• QUICK RESPONSE EXERCISES: Your short answers should be submitted on Gradescope 12 hours after the end of class. You can always submit your answers during class and then an updated versions afterwards (if needed).

• PAPERS (FINAL DRAFT): The final draft of your paper will be submitted on Gradescope. See the assignment for details.

Policy on Technical Difficulties

Waiting until the last minute to submit the work is inevitably when things go wrong. All parts of this course are designed with a 24-hour margin of error, which means you should be able to finish and submit all work 24 hours before it is due. Examples of technical difficulties include (but are not limited to): being unable to reduce the file size sufficiently, not knowing how to submit assignments, forgetting to upload a file, internet going down, etc. Technical difficulties are different from "Technical Errors" for which regrades are available (see "Technical Errors Regrade"). I cannot and/or will not help you if you have technical difficulties, so do not email the TA or me**. You should use the "help" feature on Canvas (in the grey sidebar) for Canvas-specific issues.** The Canvas Support staff are available 24/7/365. If you have problems on Canvas, also use the "report a problem" feature in that same menu. **Gradescope has a "contact us" email in their FAQ section.** Technical difficulties are usually not a reason for a regrade or an extension, though I may make an exception to this if you email me 48 hours in advance of a potential issue: so let me know ahead of time if there is any chance of a problem.

The following will automatically result in a zero score for either the homework assignment or question, as applicable (non-negotiable, no exceptions under ANY condition):

a) You do not turn in the assessment through Gradescope (If you email it to the TA or me, it will not be considered submitted).
b) Your file will not open or cannot be read due to poor quality.
c**)** You submit the wrong file. We will grade the version of the file you submitted; even if it is not the version you intended to submit. You can re-upload and change your answers until the assignment deadline.

Technical Error Regrade Policy

You can claim two regrades for technical errors (this is different from the unlimited general regrades, see below). Example: On one assignment, you uploaded the swapped two image files for a question, and on another assignment, all your images were upside down: those are two different technical errors. Exception: We will not regrade any portion of work that is not submitted by the deadline: if you submit the same image for every question, you cannot use a technical regrade to submit the correct image for each question later. Late or forgotten assignments are not covered under technical regrades.

General Regrade Policy

Any possible grading errors---and these may occur---**must be brought to my attention using the Gradescope "Request Regrade" feature within 7 days** of the return of the assignment. If necessary, this will trigger the regrade for the entire class. After 7 days, regrades will not be allowed. This is to encourage you to review your assignment immediately.

The regrade request must contain the following information:

i. The correct answer (from the answer key on Canvas).
ii. Why your answer is consistent with the correct answer.

COURSE SCHEDULE

The following represents an outline of the due dates. As the course progresses, the Lecture Topics associated with each class will be updated to reflect what was covered. If material changes, the date of assessments will **NOT** change, but content will be altered.

Week	Date	DLS	Lecture Topic	Due
	M, Sep 27	-	The Role of Theory and Data	
1	W, Sep 29	12, 13	Steady State Analysis: Lump Sum Taxation	
	Fri, Oct. 1		*Discussion: Review*	Review (Morning, Not graded)
	M, Oct 4	12, 13	Transition Analysis: Lump Sum Taxation	
2	W, Oct 6	13	Proportional Taxation	
	F, Oct 8		*Discussion: HW1*	
	M, Oct 11	14	Optimal Taxation	HW1
3	W, Oct 13	14	Optimal Government Debt	
	F, Oct 15		*Discussion: HW2*	
	M Oct 18	12	Government Spending	HW2
4	W, Oct 20	12, 13	Social Security & Redistribution	
	F, Oct 22		Fiscal Paper Peer Feedback/FoF (Pieters)	FP Draft (Morning)
	M, Oct 25	-	Taxation Behavior	FP Peer Feedback
5	W, Oct 27	10	Unemployment Insurance	Fiscal Paper/ FoF
	F, Oct 29		*Discussion: HW3*	
	M, Nov 1	4	Money as a Medium of Exchange	HW3
6	W, Nov 3	8	Money as a Storage Vehicle	
	F, Nov 5		*Discussion: HW4*	
	M, Nov 8	8	Money as a Unit of Account	HW4
7	W, Nov 10	19	Price Misperceptions	
	F, Nov 12		*Discussion: HW5*	
	M, Nov 15	18	Seigniorage and Government Debt	HW5
8	W, Nov 17	15	Gold Standard and Exchange Rates	
	F, Nov 19		*Discussion Cancelled*	MP Draft (Sunday)
	M, Nov 22		*Thanksgiving Break*	
-	W, Nov 24		*Thanksgiving Break*	
	F, Nov 26		*Thanksgiving Break*	
	M, Nov 29	18, 19	Monetary Policy and Interest Rates	MP Peer Reviews
9	W, Dec 1	19	Central Bank Commitment Problem	Monetary Paper / FoF
	F, Dec 3*, **		*Discussion: HW6*	
Finals	F, Dec 10***		Final Paper	HW6, Final Paper

§ The chapter numbers serve only as reference in the core textbook. You should also review the material posted to Canvas (the class slides and the supplementary papers, articles, and reference chapters from other textbooks). *Last day to Withdraw. See "Other Course Grades" on page 7 for details. **Dec 4th is grade deadline for graduating seniors. ***Pass/Fail must be declared via email **by the start** of the final exam's slot time. Dec 15th is grade deadline for non-graduating student.

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[1] FERPA https://registrar.uchicago.edu/records/ferpa/
[2] Responsible Employees https://equalopportunityprograms.uchicago.edu/title-ix/confidential-resources/
[3] Petitions, Audio, and video Recording on Campus https://studentmanual.uchicago.edu/administrative-policies/additional-administrative-regulations/petitions-audio-video-recording-on-campus/
[4] GoForward COVID Updates: https://goforward.uchicago.edu/
[5] UChicago Health Pact https://goforward.uchicago.edu/health-requirements/#healthpact
[6] UCAIR https://ehs-prd-01.uchicago.edu/ehsa-ucair/InjuryIllnessIndexUOFC-IT.html
[7] UChicago Student Wellness: https://wellness.uchicago.edu/
[8] Student Health and Counseling Services (SHCS) https://wellness.uchicago.edu/mental-health/
[9] SHCS Let's Talk https://wellness.uchicago.edu/mental-health/lets-talk/
[10] SHCS Therapy Groups https://wellness.uchicago.edu/mental-health/therapy-groups/
[11] SHCS Counseling https://wellness.uchicago.edu/mental-health/counseling/
[12] Academic Skills Assessment Program (ASAP) https://wellness.uchicago.edu/mental-health/academic-skills-assessment-program/
[13] Student Disability Services (SDS) https://disabilities.uchicago.edu/
[14] Tutor Program https://college.uchicago.edu/academics/college-core-tutor-program
[15] Center for College Student Success https://college.uchicago.edu/student-services/center-college-student-success
[16] Tech Bar at Regenstein: https://its.uchicago.edu/techbar/techbar-equipment-lending-terms-and-conditions/
[17] Chicago Public Library https://www.chipublib.org/library-laptop-use-guidelines/
[18] cVPN https://its.uchicago.edu/2018/09/11/training-tip-cvpn/
[19] vLAB https://academictech.uchicago.edu/vlab/
[20] Career Advancement https://careeradvancement.uchicago.edu/about
[21] Emailing guide http://www.jamestierney.com/educator/how-to-email-a-professor/
[22] Undergraduate Econ https://economics.uchicago.edu/content/undergraduate-program
[23] CCRF Research Opportunity Database https://ccrf.uchicago.edu/research-opportunity-search
[24] Oeconomica https://voices.uchicago.edu/oeconomica/
[25] Grading Options http://collegecatalog.uchicago.edu/thecollege/takingcourses/
[26] Gradescope (Get Started) https://www.gradescope.com/get_started#student-submission
[27] Group Assignments on Gradescope https://help.gradescope.com/article/m5qz2xsnjy-student-add-group-members